

MacroWatch

Data Reference Cheat Sheet

Complete guide to every indicator, its legend, signal interpretation, and Dalio framework relevance

How to Read the Color Codes

GREEN = Good / Healthy / Normal

YELLOW = Caution / Monitor / Borderline

RED = Warning / Stress / Action Required

Note: For some indicators, UP is bad (e.g., VIX up = more fear). For others, UP is good (e.g., auction BTC up = stronger demand). The color code always reflects whether the situation is healthy or stressed — not just the direction of movement.

DAILY TAB

Regime Signals (top of Daily tab)

These three derived indicators give an instant macro health read:

Signal	Formula	Green = Good	Red = Warning	Dalio Meaning
Term Premium	10Y yield minus 2Y yield	STEEPENING (curve flattening)	FLATTENING/INVERTED (recession signal)	Rising = pricing recession. Steepening = not
Liquidity	SPX divided by Fed Broad USD	EXPANDING	CONTRACTING	Rising = risk assets strong vs dollar. Falling = flight to quality
Gold/Yield	Gold price divided by 10Y yield	NORMAL range	DISTRUST (ratio very high)	High ratio = market distrusting paper assets, price up

Metals & Commodities

Indicator	Source	Refresh	Signal Interpretation
Gold (XAU/USD)	gold-api.com	Real-time	Rising gold = inflation hedge demand, reserve currency distrust, or geopolitical risk
Silver (XAG/USD)	gold-api.com	Real-time	Tracks gold but also has industrial use. Gold/Silver ratio rising = risk-off (gold outperforms)
WTI Crude (USD/bbl)	OilPriceAPI.com	~30 min	Oil up = inflation pressure, reduces Fed ability to cut. Oil down sharply (e.g., -10%) = recession risk
Brent Crude (USD/bbl)	OilPriceAPI.com	~30 min	Global benchmark. Brent premium over WTI = geopolitical/supply disruption. Volatility high

FX & Volatility

Indicator	Source	Signal Interpretation
Fed Broad USD	FRED (daily)	Fed's trade-weighted dollar index vs 26 currencies. NOT the ICE DXY (~98). Rising = dollar strength
EUR/USD	open.er-api.com (hourly)	EUR/USD falling = dollar strengthening. Below 1.05 = significant dollar strength. Above 1.10 = weakness
USD/JPY	open.er-api.com (hourly)	Rising USD/JPY = yen weakening. BOJ intervention threshold historically around 150

VIX Fear Index	FRED VIXCLS (1-day lag)	CBOE Volatility Index. <15 = Complacent (GREEN). 15-20 = Normal (GREEN). 20-30 = Elevated (RED). >30 = Extreme (RED).
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Treasury Yields

Indicator	Source	Signal Interpretation
2-Year Note	FRED (1-day lag)	Most sensitive to Fed policy expectations. 2Y rising = market pricing higher rates for longer.
10-Year Note	FRED (1-day lag)	Benchmark for mortgages, corporate debt, global borrowing costs. Above 5% = serious inflation concerns.
30-Year Bond	FRED (1-day lag)	Longest duration. Most sensitive to inflation expectations and supply concerns. 30Y rising = inflation fears.
Fed Funds Rate	FRED EFFR (daily)	Actual overnight rate, not just target. Currently 3.50-3.75%. 4 dissents at April 29 meeting.
10Y TIPS Real Yield	FRED (daily)	Yield after inflation. Above 2% = restrictive real borrowing conditions. Negative = Fed easing.

AUCTIONS TAB

Treasury auctions are the most important real-time stress test for US debt sustainability. Unlike secondary market yields (which reflect trading), auctions show actual primary demand from real buyers making real decisions.

Metric	GREEN	YELLOW	RED	Why It Matters
Bid-to-Cover (BTC)	≥ 2.50x	2.30-2.50x	< 2.30x	Total bids submitted / amount offered. Low BTC = buyers scarce =
Indirect Bidders %	≥ 68%	62-68%	< 62%	Foreign central banks buying through Fed as custodian. Declining in
Dealer Takedown %	≤ 14%	14-18%	> 18%	Primary dealers absorbing what others didn't buy. High dealer % =
TAIL (bp)	< 0.5bp	0.5-1.0bp	> 1.0bp	High yield at auction minus when-issued yield. Positive tail = buyers
Status Label	STRONG	MIXED	WEAK / PENDING	PENDING = Treasury data not yet published (normal for recent auc

Current Auction Trend (as of May 2026):

Indirect bidders consistently below 62% threshold = active foreign demand retreat warning. Dealer takedown elevated on 2Y note. Combined signal: foreign buyers stepping back, dealers forced to absorb = Dalio warning of monetization pressure ahead.

WEEKLY TAB

Fed Policy

Indicator	Current Value	Signal Interpretation
Fed Funds Rate	3.50%-3.75% (hardcoded)	Target rate held since [last FOMC]. 4 dissents at April 29 meeting = most si
Next Meeting	2026-06-16 (hardcoded)	Update after each FOMC meeting.
Market Cut Prob (Jun)	6% (hardcoded from CME)	CME FedWatch probability of a cut at next meeting. Low = market not pricin

Labor Market

Indicator	Source	Green = Healthy	Red = Warning
Unemployment Rate	FRED/BLS monthly	< 4%	> 5% (rising trend)
NFP (Non-Farm Payrolls)	FRED/BLS monthly	> +150k/month	< 0 (job losses)
Initial Jobless Claims	FRED/DOL weekly	< 220k	> 300k (sustained)
Continuing Claims	FRED/DOL weekly	< 1.8M	> 2.5M (rising trend)

Inflation

Indicator	Source	Interpretation
CPI MoM	FRED/BLS monthly	Month-over-month change in Consumer Price Index. Above +0.4% MoM = annualize
Core CPI MoM	FRED/BLS monthly	Excludes food and energy. More stable signal. Sticky core CPI = Fed cannot cut.

PCE MoM	FRED/BEA monthly	Fed's preferred inflation measure. Weights consumption differently from CPI. Above
Core PCE MoM	FRED/BEA monthly	Most important single inflation indicator for Fed. Fed target = 2% YoY = ~+0.17% Mo

Economic Activity

Indicator	Source	Interpretation
GDP (annualized)	FRED/BEA quarterly	Q1 2026: +2.0%. Positive = not in recession. Below +1% = stagnation risk. Negative
Retail Sales	FRED/Census monthly	Consumer spending health. Rising = consumer strong. Falling = demand destruction
10Y TIPS Real Yield	FRED daily	Above 2% = restrictive. Between 0-2% = neutral. Negative = financial repression = D

MONTHLY TAB

TIC Foreign Holdings

Treasury International Capital data — official record of foreign holdings. Released ~45 days after month end. Changes are month-over-month (MoM).

Country	Latest (Feb 2026)	MoM	Signal
Japan	\$1,239.3B	+\$14B	Largest holder. Buying to support yen carry trade.
United Kingdom	\$897.3B	+\$17.6B	Financial center / custody hub. Rising.
China, Mainland	\$693.3B	-\$1.1B	Long-term selling trend. Down from \$1.3T peak (2013). Net -\$185B since 2013.
Belgium	\$454.7B	+\$3.7B	Euroclear custody hub for European institutions.
Canada	\$446.3B	+\$50.5B	Significant buyer in Feb 2026.
Luxembourg	\$445.7B	-\$0.3B	European financial center.
Cayman Islands	\$443B	+\$10.2B	Hedge fund custody hub.
France	\$395.1B	+\$14.6B	Rising.
TOTAL	\$9,487.1B	+\$197.7B	Foreign share of debt: 26.2%. Broadly stable but China trend is key risk.

Fed Balance Sheet (H.4.1)

Item	Value (Apr 29, 2026)	Dalio Significance
Total Assets	\$6.70T	Peak was \$8.9T (2022). QT reduced it. Still historically elevated = unresolved QT.
Treasuries (SOMA)	\$4.43T	Fed's Treasury holdings. Represents monetized debt. Not selling = passive QT.
MBS	\$1.98T	Mortgage-backed securities. Legacy QE holdings.
Bank Reserves	\$2.92T	Excess reserves held at Fed. Near operational minimum. Below \$3T = potential QT.
Weekly Change	-\$7.5B (w/e Apr 29)	QT pace. Negative = balance sheet shrinking. Near zero = QT effectively ended.

Treasury Cash (TGA)

Treasury General Account — the US government's checking account at the Fed. Current: \$988.1B (prior month \$1,007.2B).

GREEN: Above \$500B — comfortable buffer

YELLOW: \$200-500B — manageable but watch issuance

RED: Below \$200B — Treasury must issue heavily = potential market disruption

Basis Trade / Repo Stress

The Treasury basis trade involves hedge funds buying cash Treasuries and selling futures, capturing the price differential. When leveraged positions unwind (as in March 2020), repo markets seize. Current: \$0.8T estimated, SOFR-Treasury spread 8bp = LOW STRESS.

GREEN: SOFR-Treasury spread < 10bp — normal

YELLOW: 10-25bp — elevated but contained
RED: > 25bp or rising rapidly — repo stress, potential Fed intervention needed

QTR TAB

Earnings

Real Fintnhub/SEC EDGAR data. Shows EPS actual vs estimate and beat/miss percentage.

BEAT = EPS actual > estimate (GREEN)

MISS = EPS actual < estimate (RED)

Key Dalio signal: If Big Tech (Mag7) starts missing estimates, equity valuations that assume AI-driven productivity gains are vulnerable to a 10-20% correction.

Government Reports

Report	Current Value	Source	Note
Fed Funds Rate	3.50-3.75%	FOMC (hardcoded)	Hardcoded — update after each FOMC meeting
GDP Q1 2026	+2.0%	BEA advance estimate	Annualized. Not in recession but below trend.
Federal Deficit YTD	\$1.307T through Mar 2026	Treasury MTS (hardcoded)	Track for ~\$2T annual deficit
Federal Debt Outstanding	\$38.9T	TreasuryDirect (hardcoded)	Update monthly
Debt-to-GDP	122%	BEA/CBO (hardcoded)	Gross debt basis. Above all historical safe thresholds.
Trade Balance	-\$60.3B (Mar 2026)	BEA (hardcoded)	Goods and services. Wide deficit = USD outflows.

INTEL TAB

The Intel tab uses Claude AI to generate a macro intelligence briefing anchored to verified live market data. Hit REFRESH to generate a fresh briefing.

Regime Classification

Regime	Conditions	Typical Positioning
STAGFLATION	Inflation above target + growth slowing	Cash, commodities, short duration bonds, defensive equities
REFLATION	Growth recovering + moderate inflation	Risk assets, cyclicals, commodities
DEFLATION	Falling prices + weak growth	Long bonds, cash, defensive quality
GOLDILOCKS	Moderate growth + tame inflation	Equities, credit, duration neutral
CRISIS	Financial system stress	Cash, gold, short equities, safe havens

Active Signals

Color-coded alerts generated by Claude based on current data:

RED border = CRITICAL — immediate attention required

YELLOW border = WARNING — monitor closely

BLUE border = WATCH — emerging situation

Positioning Signals

Asset	Signal Type	Interpretation
USD	NEUTRAL-TO-SHORT / UNDERWEIGHT	Watch for dollar. SHORT = expect dollar to weaken.
GOLD	OVERWEIGHT / UNDERWEIGHT	Watch allocation. OVERWEIGHT = hold more than benchmark.
LONG BONDS	UNDERWEIGHT / OVERWEIGHT	Watch exposure. UNDERWEIGHT = reduce 10Y/30Y exposure.
EQUITIES	NEUTRAL / UNDERWEIGHT	Watch equity allocation. Quality bias = favor profitable, low-leverage companies.

Big Cycle Lens (Dalio Framework)

The bottom section of Intel provides a 2-3 sentence summary of where the US sits in Dalio's long-term debt cycle. Key concepts:

- Late-cycle = debt service costs rising, policy constrained, foreign buyers retreating
- Policy capitulation = Fed forced to cut despite inflation (beautiful deleveraging beginning)
- Multipolar reserve system = USD losing exclusive reserve status, gold and alternatives rising
- Bifurcated world = US relatively resilient vs Eurozone/China entering deflationary pinch

Ask a Macro Question

The text box at the top of Intel allows you to ask any macro question. Claude answers using the same live data context as the briefing. Example questions:

- What does weak auction demand signal for the dollar?
- How does China selling Treasuries affect US interest rates?
- What is the difference between QE and QT and where are we now?
- What does a 10% oil drop mean for inflation expectations?
- How does the basis trade affect Treasury market stability?